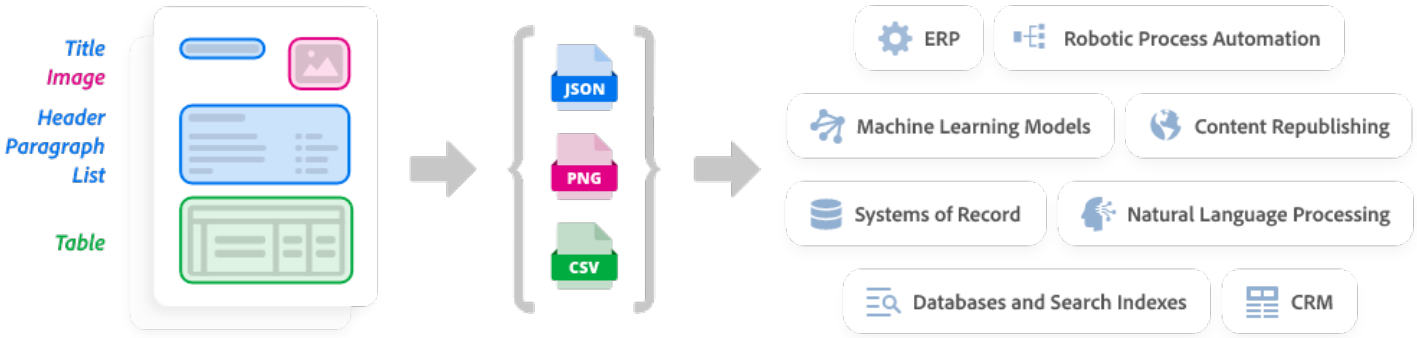
About PDF Extract API & PDF to Markdown API

Structured Information Output Format

Introduction

Extracted content is produced in a structured JSON file and/or a Markdown document. Tables can be included as HTML tables inside the Markdown or as separate CSV/XLSX files inside the JSON ZIP. Images are provided as PNG files in the JSON ZIP and as base64-embedded images in the Markdown output to make it LLM-friendly and self-contained.
This dual-output approach lets developers choose:

- JSON for programmatic processing and storage, or
- Markdown for quick LLM consumption, manual review, or documentation workflows. Provides a single file convenience with no need of post-processing.



The output of an SDK extract operation is a zip package containing the following:

The structuredData.json file with the extracted content & PDF element structure. See the JSON schema for a description of the default output. (Please refer the Styling JSON schema for a description of the output when the styling option is enabled.)

The output of an SDK markdown operation is a .md file containing the following:

The extracted content rendered as Markdown with preserved structure, headings, paragraphs, lists, tables and inline elements in reading order. Images are included as base64 URIs.

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List of key components

The following is a summary of key components in the extracted JSON:

- Elements: Ordered list of semantic elements (like headings, paragraphs, tables, figures) found in the document, on the basis of position in the structure tree of the document. The output does not include headers or footers. In addition, headings that repeat across pages are reported for the first occurrence only.
- Bounds: Bounding box enclosing the content items forming this element. Not reported for elements which don't have any content items (like empty table cells).
- Font: Font description for the font associated with the first character. Only reported for text elements.
- TextSize: Text size (in points) of the last character. Only reported for text elements.
- Attributes: Includes additional properties like line height and text alignment.
- Path: The Path describes the location of elements in the structure tree including the element type and the instance number. Element types are based on the ISO standard[1], a summary is included for convenience.
- Text: Text for the element in UTF-8 format, only reported for text elements. When inline elements are reported separately from parent block element, then this value has references to those inline elements.
- Figures: Identified as a Figure in the Path attribute, saved as a PNG in the figures folder with the filename identified in the filePaths attribute.
- Tables: Identified as a Table in the Path attribute, saved as a .CSV, .XLSX, and .PNG in the tables folder with the filename identified in the filePaths attribute.
- FilePaths: List of file paths to additional output files (images and spreadsheets)
- Pages: A list of properties for each page of the PDF including page number, width, height, and rotation.
- Reading Order: The reading order of content within columns, across page breaks, and inclusive of asides is represented by the order of the elements in the Elements array. In the normal mode, exceptions can occur for elements extracted from their container (eg. A reference link in the middle of a paragraph). However, the order is preserved in Styling mode where all Elements and their Kids are represented in the natural reading order.

How are businesses using PDF Extract API & PDF to Markdown API?

Some common and relevant use cases for Extract API include: loan document workflows, content based process automation, data analysis, processing employee resumes, field service management, and stream-line procurement processes.

Some common and relevant use cases for PDF to Markdown API include: LLM-friendly content ingestion and prompt creation, Training/Fine-tuning LLM with PDF's, Markdown-based documentation publishing and developer portals, searchable internal knowledge repositories and note-taking.

[1] ISO 32000-2 defines PDF 2.0 and is the first PDF specification entirely developed under the ISO open consensus-based process.

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SUMMARY OF ELEMENT TYPES

CATEGORY	ELEMENT TYPE	DESCRIPTION
Aside	Aside	Content which is not part of regular content flow of the document
Figure	Figure	Non-reflowable constructs like graphs, images, flowcharts
Footnote	Footnote	Footnote
Headings`	H	Beginning of heading
	H1	Heading Level 1
	H2	Heading Level 2
	etc	Heading Level X
List	L	Beginning of list
	Li	List Item
	Lbi	List Item label
	Lbody	List Item body
Paragraph	P	Paragraph
	ParagraphSpan	Denotes part of a paragraph. Reported when paragraph is broken (generally due to page break or column break)
Reference	Reference	Link
Section	Sect	Logical section of the document
StyleSpan	StyleSpan	Denotes difference in styling of text relative to the parent container
Sub	Sub	Single line of a multiline paragraph (e.g. addresses). Such paras are created in html using inside <p> tags
Table	Table	Beginning of table
	TD	Table cell
	TH	Table header cell
	TR	Table row
Title	Title	Title of the document. This is the most prominent heading which can define the whole document.

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